MODULE 4 · MONEY MATTERS

Bank Account & PAN Card

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A bank account and a PAN card are the two documents that quietly unlock almost everything else, scholarships, part-time job payments, internships, even a SIM card sometimes. They're usually sorted out around the same time, so here's both, together.

1. Opening Your First Bank Account

As of a 2025 RBI rule, this is genuinely easier for teenagers than it used to be.

- If you're 10 or older, you can open and independently operate your own savings account, no parent needs to be present for every transaction, though banks set their own limits on balance and usage.
- If you're under 10, the account still exists, but a parent or guardian operates it on your behalf.
- Documents needed: your birth certificate or school ID, a passport-size photo, and your guardian's ID and address proof (Aadhaar works for most of this).
- Most major banks offer specific student or minor accounts (often called "Young Saver," "Junior," or similar), usually with zero or low minimum balance requirements, built for exactly this stage.
- Ask about a debit card and basic mobile banking access, most banks now offer both to minors 10+, with sensible spending limits attached.

2. Getting Your PAN Card

PAN (Permanent Account Number) is a 10-character ID from the Income Tax Department. You don't need to be earning or filing taxes to get one, and having it early is genuinely useful.

- Minors can get a PAN card too, applied for by a parent or guardian on their behalf, it's commonly done alongside opening a bank account or before a scholarship application that requires one.
- From April 2026, Aadhaar alone isn't enough for a new PAN application. You'll also need one more document, a birth certificate, Class 10 certificate, voter ID, or passport.
- Apply through the official Protean (formerly NSDL) or UTIITSL portals using Form 49A. You'll upload documents, pay a small fee (roughly Rs. 90-110 for a physical card), and can track the application online.
- Instant e-PAN, the free, Aadhaar-only option on the income tax portal, is built for adults with an Aadhaar-linked mobile number, minors generally go through the regular Protean/UTIITSL route instead.
- Everyone is allowed only one PAN, ever. Holding more than one is illegal and carries a real penalty, so if you're ever unsure whether you already have one, check before applying again.

Protean (NSDL) PAN Services · *apply for a new PAN, including for a minor*

3. Why These Two Go Together

- Banks sometimes ask for PAN details once your account balance or transactions cross certain limits, having it ready avoids a scramble later.
- Scholarships, internship stipends, and even some part-time job payments are increasingly paid directly to a bank account, and some ask for PAN details on the form.
- Getting both sorted together, ideally with a parent's help the first time, means you won't need to interrupt an application later to go find either one.

4. Quick Checklist

- Birth certificate or school ID
- A recent passport-size photo
- Guardian's Aadhaar and address proof, for opening the account
- A second ID document beyond Aadhaar, for the PAN application (birth certificate, Class 10 certificate, voter ID, or passport)

A Few Myths, Busted

Myth	Fact
You have to be 18 to have your own bank account.	Since 2025, anyone 10 or older can open and independently operate a savings account, within limits the bank sets.
PAN cards are only for adults who pay taxes.	Minors can get one too, through a guardian, and it's often needed well before you start earning.
Aadhaar alone is enough to apply for a PAN.	As of April 2026, you need one additional document beyond Aadhaar for a new PAN application.

Useful Links

Protean (NSDL) PAN Services · *apply for a new PAN card, including for a minor*

Income Tax e-Filing Portal · *Instant e-PAN and other PAN-related services*

Reserve Bank of India · *official rules on minor bank accounts and banking regulations*